

Getting Started

1.1 Difference between AS2 and AS3

Before going through the differences between ActionScript 2.0 and ActionScript 3.0, let us look at the basics of ActionScript. Without an overview of the basic ActionScript it will be difficult for us to understand the differences.

ActionScript is a scripting language that follows the Ecma (European Computer Manufacturers Association) Standard. This scripting language is used while developing either a website or software using Adobe Flash Players. ActionScript is the line of instruction that we insert in the Actions panel of Flash for the execution of some actions. We can make a webpage or software interactive by inserting ActionScript commands. Suppose you want to create a form that is to be filled in by the users. You may want to insert a ‘Submit’ button so that users or visitors to your Website can submit the form online. To do this you can insert ActionScript in the Actions panel of Flash.

The ActionScript that you insert in the Actions panel is executed by the AVM, i.e., the ActionScript Virtual Machine. This AVM is an inseparable part of the of Flash Player system. The ActionScript codes are written in a bytecode format – a programming language format. These codes are usually placed in an SWF file that can be executed by Flash Players.

When Flash Player were updated from Flash Player 2 to Flash Player 9 the version of ActionScript was also updated. There are three versions of ActionScript: ActionScript 1.0, ActionScript 2.0 and ActionScript 3.0.

The Actions panel is the container where we can insert the scripts. Now let us quickly go through the features of the Actions panel:

The Actions panel includes the following attributes:

- **Toolbox**, from where we can easily access various options, like,